

Akorn Media Inc. v. Shanghai Xinqi Electronic Technology Co., Ltd.

Portable electronic mason-jar vacuum sealers, including pump, solenoid valve, air-delivery path, lid spacing, and controller architecture under U.S. Patent No. 12,209,005.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-21	D. Utah	2:26-cv-00769	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	Akorn Media Inc. v. Shanghai Xinqi Electronic Technology Co., Ltd.
FORUM / DOCKET	D. Utah / 2:26-cv-00769
FILED / TYPE	2026-08-21 / patent infringement
PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

Akorn Media Inc. v. Shanghai Xinqi Electronic Technology Co., Ltd., No. 2:26-cv-00769, filed 2026-08-21 in D. Utah.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

David P. Johnson - Workman Nydegger; named matter counsel. The public docket identifies Johnson as the attorney who filed the declaratory-judgment complaint. Selecting the complaint filer as likely purchaser is an analytical inference from that role.

djohnson@wnlaw.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Portable electronic mason-jar vacuum sealers, including pump, solenoid valve, air-delivery path, lid spacing, and controller architecture under U.S. Patent No. 12,209,005.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. 12,209,005](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 How do the claimed pump, solenoid valve, air path, jar-lid spacing, seals, controller, and timing interact to evacuate and release a mason jar?

How do the claimed pump, solenoid valve, air path, jar-lid spacing, seals, controller, and timing interact to evacuate and release a mason jar?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 Which accused components perform each patent limitation, under what operating sequence and pressure profile?

Which accused components perform each patent limitation, under what operating sequence and pressure profile?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 What prior vacuum-packaging appliances and public pump/valve architectures bear on validity and claim scope?

What prior vacuum-packaging appliances and public pump/valve architectures bear on validity and claim scope?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Kay Cooksey

Professor and Cryovac Endowed Chair in Packaging Science, Clemson University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for food packaging, vacuum packaging context, package performance, and industry standards.

RELEVANT WORK

Cryovac-endowed packaging professor with industrial packaging experience and advanced food-packaging teaching.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Focus is packaging systems rather than miniature pump/solenoid circuit design.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | kcookse@clemson.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Kit L. Yam

Professor of Food Science, Rutgers University

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for vacuum and modified-atmosphere packaging, gas/vapor permeation, seals, and food-package interactions.

RELEVANT WORK

Teaches Food Packaging Science and Technology including vacuum packaging and packaging operations.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The public email source is a course syllabus; current role/contact should be refreshed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | kyam@sebs.rutgers.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Christopher Miller

Professor and Packaging Engineering Undergraduate Director, Rutgers University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for packaging automation, sustainable packaging systems, electromechanical integration, and product architecture.

RELEVANT WORK

Leads Rutgers packaging engineering and works on automation and packaging systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Profile does not show a vacuum-pump or solenoid-valve publication.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | cm1700@connect.rutgers.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Changfeng Ge

Professor of Packaging and Graphic Media Science, Rochester Institute of Technology

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for protective-package design, modeling, barrier properties, mechanical performance, and testing.

RELEVANT WORK

Founding director of RIT packaging innovation center; chairs ASTM packaging work and publishes on simulation.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Less directly focused on household vacuum appliances and embedded controllers.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | cfgmet@rit.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 William Whiteside

Professor of Food Systems and Safety, Clemson University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for food-package machinery, package design, sealing, shelf life, and commercial processing.

RELEVANT WORK

Teaches packaging machinery/design and advises industry on food packaging and processing.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Not a pump or electronic-control specialist.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | wwhtsd@clemson.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Duncan Darby

Professor of Packaging Science, Clemson University

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for package sealing/welding and flexible-package technology.

RELEVANT WORK

Chemical engineer whose teaching and research focus on flexible packaging and seal formation.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Narrower fit to jar-lid spacing, air paths, and controller claim elements.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ddarby@clemson.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Gregory Batt

Professor of Packaging Science, Clemson University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for package dynamics, testing, machinery, and performance evaluation.

RELEVANT WORK

Senior faculty member in Clemson's packaging-science program with published institutional contact.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The common directory provides limited detail; specific vacuum-sealer publications require further diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | gbatt@clemson.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Andrew Hurley

Professor of Packaging Science, Clemson University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for package design, consumer packaging, and visual/functional architecture comparisons.

RELEVANT WORK

Established packaging-science educator and design researcher.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Public directory does not establish pump, solenoid, or embedded-control expertise.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ruperth@clemson.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Edmund Tang

Assistant Professor and Director of Packaging Program, San Jose State University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for packaging systems, product design, manufacturability, and program-level technical assessment.

RELEVANT WORK

Directs SJSU's packaging program and teaches packaging engineering topics.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Limited biographical detail on the cited directory; vacuum-system specialization is unconfirmed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | edmund.tang@sjsu.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Fritz Yambrach

Professor of Packaging, San Jose State University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for packaging design, materials, systems, and commercial product evaluation.

RELEVANT WORK

Longstanding packaging faculty member with publicly listed professional email.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The directory alone does not establish patent-litigation or miniature-vacuum-system experience.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | fritz.yambrach@sjsu.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/utah/utdce/2%3A2026cv00769/166442>

Official attorney biography and email: <https://wnlaw.com/wp-content/uploads/Johnson-Dave-2016.pdf>

Public technical context source: [https://ai-lab.exparte.com/case/dct/utd/2%3A26-cv-00769/doc/analysis/1](https://ai-lab.experte.com/case/dct/utd/2%3A26-cv-00769/doc/analysis/1)

LIMITATIONS

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